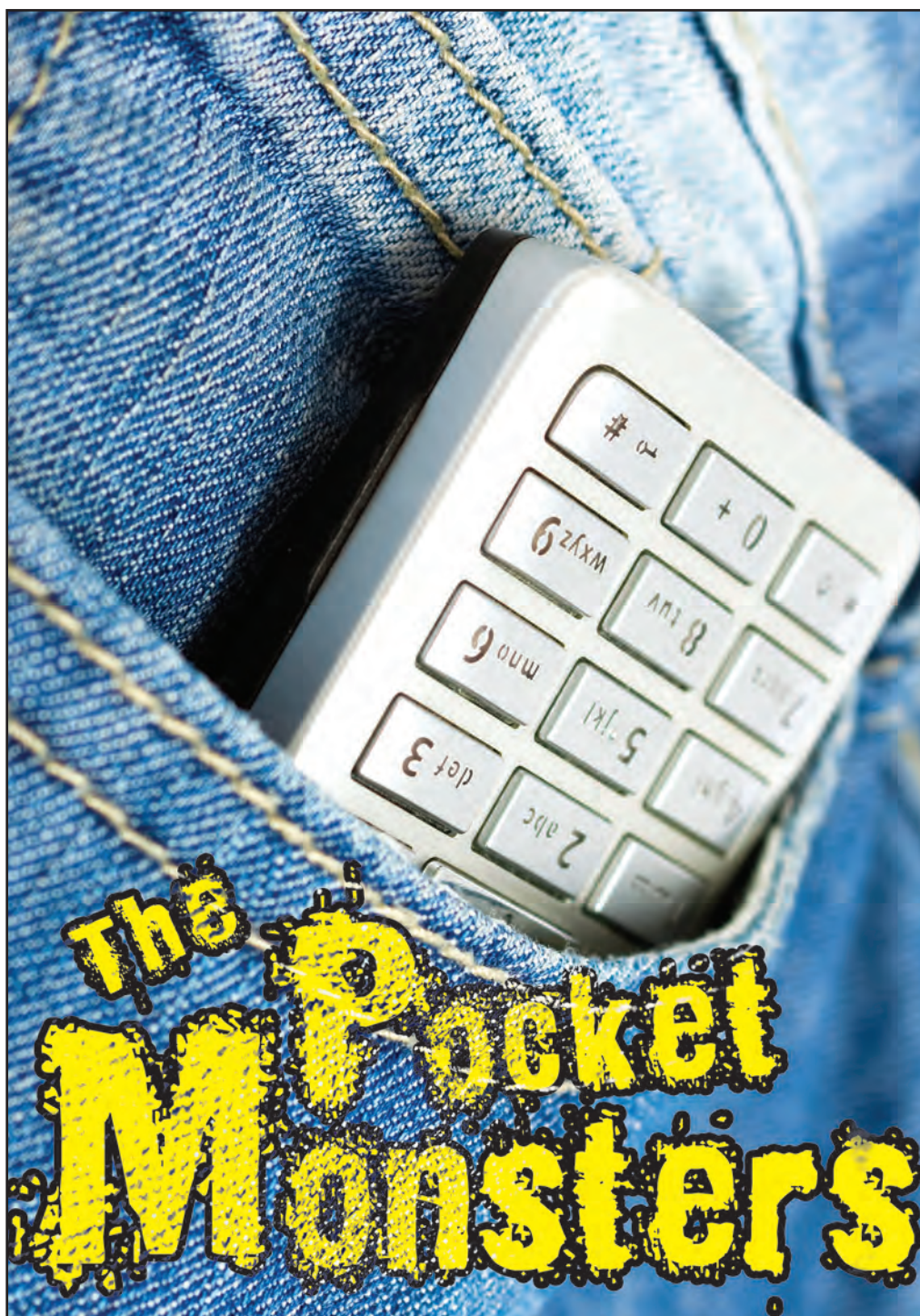


Mobile launch

Wynn telecom Ltd has launched budget mobile handsets priced between Rs. 1,500 and Rs. 5,000 with a wide variety of choice in utility, multimedia and QWERTY phones

3G auctions

Airtel, Reliance Communications and Aircel have won bids in 13 circles in the recently conducted 3G spectrum auction.



We test 28 of the smartest phones in the Indian market ranging from Rs. 8,000 to more than Rs. 40,000. These monsters offered everything from touchscreens to QWERTY keypads, and 12.1MP HD-ready cameras to voice-guided GPS navigation.

We caught 'em all: 28 monster phones rampaging

in the Indian market. The captured specimens included offerings from the stables of Nokia, BlackBerry, HTC, Samsung, LG, Sony Ericsson, Apple, Motorola, and Garmin-ASUS; and ranged in price from Rs. 8,500 to Rs. 41,500. What these phones have in common is features that are geared towards the always-connected life, whether it is through Wi-Fi or 3G connectivity, location-based features or social networking. These features, along with the rapidly growing prevalence of touch-screen and camera phones, gives us an interesting perspective on the current state of the Indian market, where we find intense competition between some of the most advanced cellular devices in the world. These phones also herald a change in the way we communicate with the world around us.

Our experiences in testing these current-gen devices were varied and ranged from unbridled awe, to morose disappointment. Read on to find out more!

Entry-level multimedia phones (8,000 to 12,000)

Two phones fell into this price category: HTC Smart and Sony Ericsson Naite.

Sony Ericsson Naite: J105i

The Sony Ericsson Naite (J105i) is labelled as the 'Green Heart', since it is designed to be very eco-friendly with recyclable plastics and reduced packaging to help cut down on wastage of raw-materials. In addition,